

**The framework publishes non-binding criteria;
each operator applies them UNILATERALLY.
It binds no one and asks for no agreement.**

Is there an agreement among operators to refuse?

NO

- independent, parallel conduct on published criteria

Lawful. Parallel conduct without agreement is no §1 claim (Twombly); a unilateral refusal is lawful (Colgate).

The branch the framework is built for; App. B is drafted for unilateral adoption.

YES

- an actual agreement to boycott

Antitrust risk. A group boycott can be per se illegal (Klor's); its expressive character is no defense (Trial Lawyers); even a "quick look" can condemn it (Indiana Dentists).

The posture the framework never forms.